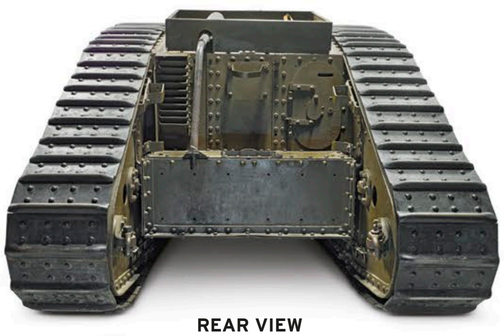
Mark IV

More Mark IVs were made than any other British tank during World War I. Although it looked similar to the earlier Mark I, it featured improvements including an armored fuel tank at the rear, and thicker 0.5 in (12 mm) frontal armor to protect against armor-piercing bullets. The sponsons housing the guns on each side could be pushed inside the tank to allow transportation by train, unlike those on the Mark I, which had to be removed.

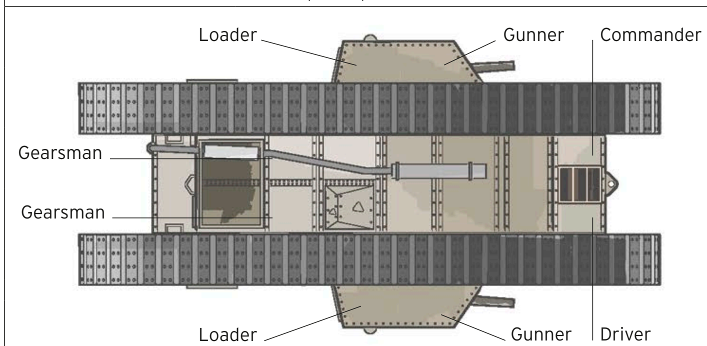


REAR VIEW

THE MARK IV made an impact at the Battle of Cambrai in November 1917, the first effective massed tank attack. Over 400 tanks were moved at night by rail to the quiet front line at Cambrai, and launched an assault, cutting deep into the German Hindenburg line.

The tank was made in “male” and “female” versions: males carried two 6-pounder guns and three machine guns, while females had five machine guns. Female tanks were considered more useful, since machine-gun fire was effective in pinning the enemy while friendly troops advanced; male tanks also had to stop to allow the 6-pounder gunner to aim. After April 1918, “hermaphrodites” with one male and one female sponson were built.

SPECIFICATIONS	
Name	Tank, Mark IV
Date	1917
Origin	UK
Production	Approx 1,220
Engine	Daimler/Knight straight six, 105 hp
Weight	31.4 tons (28.4 tonnes)
Armament (male)	2 x 6-pounder QF guns; 3 x .303 Lewis machine guns
Armament (female)	5 x .303 Lewis machine guns
Crew	8
Armor thickness	0.5 in (12 mm)



Training vehicle
After World War I, this Mark IV male tank was given to Whale Island, a Royal Navy establishment in Portsmouth, UK. Many gunners for tanks were trained here, since naval personnel were highly experienced at firing weapons from moving platforms.